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Bazaar

HP Spectre x360

The best premium ultrabook hybrid?

After a long time, HP delivers a premium, high-end ultraportable laptop that also duals up as a great hybrid device. Oh yeah. The HP Spectre x360 is every other ultrabook's envy, and its owner's pride. Dressed in an all-aluminium exterior, the Spectre x360 makes heads turn wherever you go with it – inside a corporate boardroom or at your next door coffee shop. Both on its screen lid and bottom panel, the Spectre x360 is flush with matte aluminium finish, and feels much like a MacBook Air – exquisitely high end. Beauty is in the eye of the beholder, but on looks alone, the Spectre x360 sets the bar higher than the Lenovo YOGA 3 Pro – the most direct competitor it has.

All that generous metal exterior doesn't really weigh the Spectre x360 down, as it tips the scale at just 1.5 kg, which is not as light as the 1.3 kg of the Lenovo YOGA 3 Pro, but it's great for a 13-inch form factor ultraportable all the same. Its stainless steel hinges ensure the HP Spectre x360 feels rock solid in every position that it assumes – laptop, tent or tablet mode. The overall build quality of this premium HP hybrid is very good; so is its aesthetic appeal across all orientations.

Sporting a backlit keyboard with keys that are great to type on, the HP Spectre x360's wide touchpad is a joy to use. It's the widest touchpad we've ever seen on a laptop, and it works like a charm – no complaints whatsoever. Even the hybrid's multitouch screen is great to use, with gestures working flawlessly for the most part.

The HP Spectre x360 comes with one of the best set of internal hardware we've seen on an expensive ultrabook or high-end hybrid this year – a Core i7 chip, loads of RAM, dependable onboard graphics and a PCI-e based M.2 SSD. The transfer speeds on the PCI-e SSD are faster than regular SATA-based ones, and that really shows on the HP Spectre x360's performance. Booting up, opening or closing applications, tasks just seem to finish in the blink of an eye, and that's a great feeling to have, especially given the price tag. The device's multimedia potential is very good with nice visuals and encouraging audio performance. Its screen is nice and bright at 232.8 cd/m², and its contrast ratio is good, too. Typing on the screen in tablet mode does put down a lot of fingerprints on the surface but you hardly notice it given the angle at which you view the screen. Multitasking on a number of apps isn't an



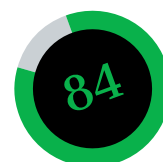
issue on the HP Spectre x360, thanks to its impressive combination of processor, oodles of RAM and superfast SSD. Only thing it can't do? High-end gaming. But then it's not meant for gamers, so we can't really fault it.

What's surprising about the HP Spectre x360 is despite its performance-hungry specs, it still manages to churn out pretty good battery performance. This is a testament to the fact that the PCIe M.2 SSD consumes a lot less power than a traditional hard drive. In our synthetic benchmark at high performance preset, its battery lasted for 3 hours 36 minutes – that's greater than the Lenovo YOGA 3 Pro's. We have no doubt it will sail past the 5 hour mark on a more conservative battery plan, and that's just wonderful.

Another important feature of the Spectre x360 is that it comes with TPM (Trusted Platform Module) for hardware-level encryption, a security feature that its audience will no doubt appreciate, among other things.

This HP Spectre x360 SKU doesn't have as much storage as the Yoga 3 Pro SKU that we'd reviewed earlier and it isn't as light but it has a better processor and onboard graphics combo and a much faster PCI-e SSD. And it's a looker, much like the MacBook Air. In fact, to say that the HP Spectre x360 takes the best of what the Lenovo YOGA 3 Pro and the Apple MacBook Air has to offer would be an apt compliment to its prowess. Highly recommended, go for it.

Jayesh Shinde



Features	85
Performance	80
Design	90
Value	80

Specifications

Screen: 13.3-inch, QHD IPS multitouch display, 2560x1440 res; **CPU:** Dual-core Intel Core i7-5500U 2.4 GHz processor; **RAM:** 8 GB DDRIII; **Storage:** 256 GB M.2 SSD; **GPU:** Intel HD 5500; **OS:** 64-bit Windows 8.1 Professional; **I/O:** 3xUSB 3.0, 1xHDMI out, mini-DisplayPort, 3.5 mm headphone jack, SD Card reader; **Wireless:** Wi-Fi 802.11ac, Bluetooth 4.0; **Battery:** 3-cell Li-ion Polymer; **Weight:** 1.48 kg; **Warranty:** 3 years

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